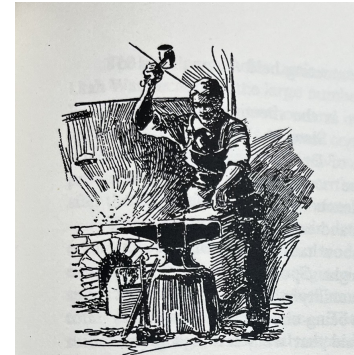




CHAPTER XVII

CEDAR CITY MOVED TO FINAL LOCATION IRON WORKS ABANDONED 1858 – 1860

Cedar City was fortunate not to have been involved actively in the Utah War. However, the entire state was considered to be at war, and it involved the majority of the population and most of the state's productive resources. The return of the settlers to their homes in northern Utah had ended in poverty and disappointment. The picture of 30,000 pioneers trudging back to their hard-won homes, farms and orchards to the accompaniment of jeers from the army would live long in the hearts and minds of the pioneer leaders. Because the Saints from California and other outlying settlements had sold their property mostly to "gentiles", many, who left their homes never returned. In the long run the settlers were able to purchase property estimated to be worth four million dollars, for approximately \$100,000 when the army left Utah. This improved the circumstances of most of the people remaining in Utah.¹

The secretary of the Cedar Ward Relief Society, Ellen Lunt, kept accurate minutes of the meetings which were held once a week. Even after the ending of the war, the saints were wary of the Army. The

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following are the minutes of the meeting held August 12, 1858:

The members met at the meeting house two o'clock p.m. on Thursday. Sister A. Haight gave the meeting into the hands of Brother Henry Lunt, he being present. Opened the meeting by singing. Prayer by Brother Lunt. The teachers gave in their report. Brother Lunt then arose and said that he had no idea of being here this afternoon had it not been through the invitation of Sister Haight. Spoke on humility. He believed in that kind of humility where the people did as they were told, even in being obedient to those that were over them. He said that we were in a great school to learn human nature, that we had many difficulties to encounter, but if we would be humble and first seek the Kingdom of God and its righteousness, all other things would be added. Brother Morris then advised the sisters how to act in regard to selling bread stuffs to the army such as butter, cheese, eggs, etc. He told them to be wise and listen to counsel and not undermine the prices that had been given by the Priesthood. Counseled them not to sell any wheat at all, but to keep it that we might become independent of those who are seeking our destruction. Said that he believed the test that had been spoken of was now upon this people. Spoke on many things for the benefit of the Sisters.

Henry Lunt wrote the following in his journal:

July 25. 1858: Amasa Lyman and George A. Smith came to Cedar and preached principally on the necessity of home manufacture and that, before this people could become a rich and independent people, they would have to quit running to Gentile stores.
Sept. 11: I was elected a member of the City Council.

The problem of colonization was particularly difficult during the Utah War because of the large number of people called back to Utah. In addition, two to four thousand immigrants were brought into the territory each year by the pioneer companies. They were people who joined the L.D.S. Church elsewhere. Homes and farms had to be provided in Utah settlements for these people. During the ten years after the end of the war, approximately 150 new towns were founded.

The people renewed their determination to achieve complete economic independence. This tendency was already an established element in the L. D. S. religious faith in the Utah of 1858 and succeeding years. The leaders staunchly felt that they could attain total economic independence. The L.D.S. leaders used the self-sufficiency program to greatly expand the southern colonies following the Utah War. A number of parties had been sent out from Parowan and Cedar City to explore the Santa Clara and Virgin River basins and to determine their suitability for producing specialized agricultural products. It was the hope of the Mormon leaders that the new region would be able to produce cotton, grapes, almonds, olive oil, figs, flax, hemp, rice, sugar cane, and other much-needed semitropical products. Small colonies were formed in the area in 1857 and 1858, which were able to grow cotton successfully on a small scale. Total production in 1860 was 155 bales.

The role of economic independence in Mormon colonization was illustrated by a mission fifty miles to the south of Cedar City, the Cotton Mission. Eventually more than 300 families were called to go south to settle in what is now called "Utah's Dixie." They represented a variety of occupations and were instructed to contribute their efforts to supply the Territory with the aforementioned products. In addition to cotton, Brigham Young specifically desired them to produce tobacco and wine in order to eliminate buying these articles, which were mainly sold to "outsiders." The Church leaders continued to send settlers to this area to accomplish this task. The people became discouraged when, in addition to many other obstacles, the soil was found to be poor because of minerals. Later the L.D.S. Church even appropriated tithing money to build a tabernacle, and several years later a temple, as a device to assist the Dixians to "hang on."²

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Late in 1858 and in early 1859 Henry wrote the following entries in his journal:

November 1, 1858: Attended a meeting of the Deseret Iron Company held in the company's store. The report showed that the Works have been attended with less success this year than ever, and yet an immense amount of labor and means has been expended. A letter has been lately received from President Brigham Young directing the Works to be stopped, which was addressed to Isaac Haight, Manager of the Works. The manager's salary, it appears, has been fifteen hundred dollars a year and that of the Secretary, C. J. Arthur, one thousand dollars a year [a large amount of money at that time]. Considerable means was furnished by the Tithing Office, and store goods, sent by the Church from Salt Lake, have been used by the general managements, to a great extent, when many of the laborers who performed the hard work have received but little, in consequence of which many became discouraged and left for other places to better their condition, as this is considered a poor place for farming.

During the remainder of 1858 and until February 1, 1859, I was very busily engaged, principally as a home missionary and many other duties. On the 21st of February, I accompanied President Isaac Haight on a preaching mission to the southern settlements. We visited Harmony, Toquerville, Washington and Virgin City, together with Santa Clara. Arrived home on the 1st of March 1859.

During my absence, while in England on a mission, President Brigham Young and Company made his annual visit through the settlements south of Salt Lake and, while in Cedar, by his direction another townsite was surveyed on the bench near to the mouth of the

canyon, as he did not consider the Old Fort site safe from floods, as Coal Creek was subject to very high water in times of flood.

Since Henry's first wife, Ellen, was not able to have children, it was six years after Henry was married before his first child was born. Mary Ann, his second wife, had a baby on November 12, 1858, before Henry left to preach and encourage the settlers in the southern settlements. Had the baby been a boy, he would have been given the name of Henry as it was customary to name the first child after his father. Since they had a girl, they decided to use Henrietta as the second name which contained the name of "Henry," and Martha as the first name. Even though her name was Martha Henrietta Lunt, she went by the name of Henrietta her entire life.

Since the massacre at Mountain Meadow and the subsequent closing of the Iron Mission, Isaac C. Haight, who had been manager of the works, had been on the run. Brigham Young wrote a letter stating: "We think it would be wise to abandon the idea of making iron for the present and let all the brethren pursue those avocations which they please."³ The release of Phillip Klingon Smith and Haight was the final move to indicate that the Iron Mission was definitely a thing of the past.

The tragedy at Mountain Meadow had a decided effect on Iron County. Many people moved after the event. Even more moved after the abandoning of the Iron Works. The remaining settlers were left with little hope of making a living with their trade. They either had to turn their attention to farming, dairying, raising livestock or freighting. Many of the residents of Cedar City remained only because they didn't have the means to move to another area. Meanwhile, those accused of being involved in the foregoing event were being pursued by the law. John D. Lee noted in his journal on May 28, 1859 that he had eaten his first meal at home in more than a month. The Indians, intrigued by this game of hide-and-seek, crowded to Lee's home to tell him of the bribes they had been offered for his scalp--money, horses, guns--and they would not help the "mercats" catch him. Actually, the sum offered for any of the leaders--Dame, Haight,

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Higbee, Klingensmith (P.K. Smith) or Lee--was \$5,000.⁴

Henry was sent to the southern settlements to preach and thus help with the spiritual needs of the settlers. He wrote the following in his journal after he returned:

April 1859: I bought a little Pihede Indian boy about 4 or 5 years old from an old Parvan Chief. I gave him an old rifle, a sack of flour, a shirt and an old pair of pants. We gave the boy the name of Ammon.

About this time I bought a house and lot in the new city and, on the 6th of April, moved into it from the Old Fort [100 North and High Street in Block 37].

On Sunday, the 31st of July 1859, Apostle George A. Smith drove up to my house about noon, dined with us and at two o'clock attended meeting. After the usual exercises, he arose and said, 'the President has instructed me to come and disorganize this Stake of Zion and to make Bishop and President out of one man, and I nominate Brother Henry Lunt as that man,' which was seconded by several voices. Brother Smith put it to a vote which was unanimous. Brother Smith then invited me to him and placed his hands upon my head and ordained me a Bishop to preside over the Cedar City Ward. I can truly say that I felt my inability to fulfill this high and important trust, yet I know that the Lord is able by his spirit to qualify His servants to do anything he calls them to do if they will live humble and faithful.

The Cedar Stake Journal entry of the same day contained the following:

July 31, 1859: On motion it was unanimously voted that the President and Bishopric be invested in one man. On motion, Brother George A. Smith was appointed to nominate this man. Carried. Brother

Smith said, 'The office of Bishop is a responsible one, Elder Henry Lunt was appointed. I can say for Henry Lunt, I have known him for some time, and my opinion of him is that he is a good man.'

Elder Lunt was ordained Bishop and President. Bishop Lunt motioned that Richard V. Morris be his First Counselor and Thomas Jones his Second Counselor. Carried. After some few remarks by Bishop Lunt the benediction was given by Elder G. A. Smith.⁵

Isaac C. Haight wrote the following in his journal:

July 31, 1859: Elder George A. Smith visited us and appointed another Bishop, Henry Lunt. In consequence of persecution of our enemies, I solicited to be released from the presidency of the Stake, as my enemies swore they would destroy me if they could get me.

August 7, 1859: Again left home with several of the brethren. Went into the mountains as we heard that our enemies were coming after us.⁶

Bishop Lunt inherited the problems connected with the painful aftermath of the Mountain Meadow Massacre.

While in Salt Lake City in July 1859, Wilford Woodruff recorded President Young's comments regarding his disapproval of the iron workers being involved in the confrontation at Mountain Meadow and his thoughts on the subject of home industry. Woodruff wrote:

The best thing we can do for the people would be to raise sheep, mix black and white wool, make sheep's gray and clothe the people. They must color with the products on hand. I should not buy any coloring stuffs from the States. I shall not stop my labor until we can make nails and iron. I have sent for

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nail machines and intend to make our own nails. We have spent \$20,000 dollars to make iron and, if those engaged in the business had not had the devil in them, we should have made good iron before now.⁷

Mormon construction activities were hampered by the cost of nails until the coming of the railroad in 1869. Iron goods were hauled by ox-team over a long difficult trail from St. Louis. Church leaders continually experimented with construction materials and devices which would minimize the use of nails. Some buildings were tied together with rawhide thongs and required few or no nails. One such building was the Mormon Tabernacle which still stands. The Iron Mission produced nails from wagon tires and other iron articles which had been transported into the Great Basin. Iron products made from pig iron from the Cedar City Iron Works were very limited because of the many metallurgical problems. Iron supplies became more abundant when the federal troops occupied Utah causing Brigham Young to order machinery in 1859 for manufacturing nails and screws. By April 1861, public works' employees in Salt Lake City were turning out nails by the ton.⁸

Minutes from the Cedar Stake Journal in 1859 included the following:

August 7, 1859: Meeting in the school house. Bishop Lunt bore testimony to the healing power being in the Church of God and spoke of the fruits of the Spirit. Counseled the saints to pray more and to be merciful to one another.

August 21, 1859: 10 o'clock a.m. Singing by the choir. Bishop Lunt spoke and told the saints not attending their meetings that it was a trick of the devil to keep the saints from meeting because their clothing was bad. He prophesied that the day would come that they should have abundance of everything. At the two o'clock meeting Lunt said it was his duty to speak often upon items of business and instructions. 'I feel

thankful for this day brethren, the Lord has answered our prayers.' He blessed the saints and said he knew that we would have good times spiritually and temporally. 'We have all plenty to do to mind our own business.'⁹

The last entry in Henry Lunt's journal was dated September 25, 1859. He wrote:

Went to the semiannual conference of the church at Salt Lake City accompanied by my wife, Mary Ann, and child, and returned home on the 20th of October. Had a very enjoyable and prosperous time.

The numerous duties devolving upon me as Bishop, in addition to having to farm my own land for a living for myself and family, it seems impossible for me to find time to write a daily journal.¹⁰

While at Conference in Salt Lake City, Henry and Mary Ann went to the Endowment House on October 14, 1859, and Mary Ann received her endowments. They were also sealed again by Heber C. Kimball.¹¹ Henry and Mary Ann had been married and sealed by Brigham Young on October 7, 1857, upstairs in his office.

The minutes of the Cedar Ward minute book contained the following entries:

December 4, 1859: Cedar City Ward Meeting. Bishop Lunt gave notice that conference would be held in this place on the 17th and 18th. He said he did not wish to see any sectional feelings exist between the settlements. 'Let us try to be united and do the best we can.' If ever there was a time for the faithful to be united, it is now!

December 17, 1859, 2:00 p.m. Cedar City Conference. Bishop Lunt said, 'It affords me great pleasure in meeting with my brethren and sisters in this

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conference. I feel the results of it will be good. I hope the brethren and sisters will call in the wanderings of their minds that they may be strengthened and refreshed in their most holy faith.'

December 18, 1859--Conference. Bishop Lunt presiding. It was proposed that the congregation sustain Henry Lunt as President and Bishop of Cedar City with R. V. Morris and Thomas Jones as his Counselors. All carried. Not one dissenting voice. Bishop Lunt said, 'My heart is too full to express my feelings. I feel a solemn spirit resting upon men.' The Parowan brass band was present and cheered the assembly by its sweet strains of music.¹²

Martin Slack from Cedar City wrote the following article on December 19, 1859, which was published in the *Deseret News* on February 15, 1860:

Dear Sir: [Editor of the *Deseret News*]

Enclosed are the minutes of a conference held in this city on Saturday and Sunday last. Bishop Lunt, by the judicious course he is taking, has secured the confidence and esteem of the people over whom he presides. He is zealously and successfully discharging the duties of his calling and takes great interest in the general welfare of the saints. I remain yours respectfully, Martin Slack

One of Henry's duties while he served as Bishop was to care for the Tithing Office which was actually the center of activity of the church. Because of the nature of church receipts, the task of receiving, storing, and handling the tithing, and of expending it and converting it into a form suitable to church creditors, was an exceedingly involved one. To use Brigham Young's term for it, it required "financiering" of a very high order. During the time while Henry was Bishop, tithing receipts were almost entirely "in kind."

What little was earned in the way of cash was promptly used to purchase consumer goods, pay the transportation of immigrants, and buy supplies and equipment for farms and shops. There was a real scarcity of money in Utah. The task of the tithing office was to serve as agent of the church in receiving and distributing contributions and to convert such items as were received into acceptable means of payment wherever the church made purchases, thus the tithing offices became completely immersed in the economic activities of the communities and valleys in which they were located. They served as community warehouses, general stores, banks, weighing stations, relief and employment agencies, and communication centers. By regulating the prices at which goods and services would be received they standardized prices. In the early 1850's the tithing offices also served as the postal system of the territory and received and forwarded mail by tithing labor. They often let the citizens accumulate credit, and extended consumer and producer credit by permitting individuals to withdraw tithing produce in excess of book credits. These credits could be transferred by means of "tithing scrip," which resembled the modern check. Transfers were also made from one tithing house to another in the same manner.

The Cedar City Tithing Office served the people not only as a tithing office but as a council house, city bastille, wool and grain storage location, courthouse, telegraph office, assessor's office and community butcher shop. The Cedar City Tithing Office was built in 1856 and was located on Main Street and 200 North. It was a two-story building 35 feet by 75 feet constructed of cut stone with a full concrete basement and heated by a large fireplace. Around the entire lot was a heavy stone wall eight feet high. The first story was entered from a stone platform the height of a wagon which was built that way for the convenience of unloading by those who brought grain or small produce for tithing. The tithing barn where hay was stored was in the rear of the lot. Potatoes and other vegetables, as well as cured meats, were kept in the basement. The rear room in the basement served as a city bastille while the ground floor was nicely finished and fitted with a table, desk, cupboards and shelves for an office which was large enough for a council room, bishop's court and other small meetings.

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Many very important and far reaching decisions were made there.

The front half of the second floor of the Tithing Office was fitted for a family's living quarters, while the rear half, finished throughout in spotless white and equipped with an altar, was the place where certain special priesthood prayer meetings were held.¹³ The men of the community were asked to give one-tenth of their time (every 10th day) to working on the building.

In 1867 the Deseret Telegraph line was built through the settlement from Logan, on the north, to St. George, on the south. It was extended eastward from St. George to Pipe Springs so that the settlements could be kept advised of unusual Indian movements and other events before a raiding party would be able to reach any of the Mormon settlements. The first Telegraph Office in Cedar City was in the Tithing Office and the people enjoyed the new service to the fullest. The operator collected the news that came over the wire and, once each week, the people assembled in front of the Tithing Office and the operator sat on the stone platform and read the messages to the crowd. The outside world that had been so far away in their ox-team world had been brought to the very steps of the Tithing Office.

The following are the minutes taken from the Cedar City Ward meeting on March 1, 1860:

Fast Day. Meeting--9:00 a.m. Bishop Lunt spoke: 'We may sow, plant and fence fields, but it is God that giveth the increase. The battle is not to the strong, the race to the swift, nor riches to men of wisdom. We have to think and reflect that this Kingdom will not build up without faith and works. Teach our children the object of the Fast Day.'

The following was written in the *Deseret News* on July 4, 1860:

Tithing of Iron Works. Yesterday in the afternoon Bishop Henry Lunt with a train of six wagons loaded with tithing wheat arrived from Cedar City, Iron County.

The census that was taken in Cedar City March 27, 1860 was as follows: L.D.S. Church members, 189. Over eight and not baptized, 17. Under eight (children), 118. The combined total of the inhabitants of Cedar City was 324. The men in the Church were listed as follows: 12 High Priests, 11 Seventies, 32 Elders, two Priests, one Teacher, and 14 Deacons. This added up to a total of 73.¹⁴

1. Leonard Arrington, *Great Basin Kingdom*, (University of Nebraska Press--Lincoln, 1958), p. 194.
2. *Ibid.*, page 221.
3. Brigham Young, "File of Letters" (L.D.S. Church, 1858) Page 33, Number 8.
4. Juanita Brooks, *John D. Lee*, (Arthur H. Clark Co., Glendale, California, 1972), p. 252.
5. *Cedar Stake Journal*, S.U.U. Special Collections Library, William R. Palmer Collection, F-12 & B89 Cedar City, Utah.
6. Isaac C. Haight, "Isaac C. Haight Journal," S.U.U. Special Collections Library, F-8 & B98, Cedar City, Utah.
7. Wilford Woodruff, *Wilford Woodruff Journal*, S.U.U. Special Collections Library, Cedar City, Utah, Vol. 5, p. 355.
8. George Laub, "George Laub Journal," S.U.U. Special Collections Library, Cedar City, Utah.
9. *Cedar Stake Journal*, *op. cit.*, F-2 & B89.
10. Henry Lunt, "Henry Lunt Journal," (Provo, Utah: B.Y.U. Library, copied in 1955 from original manuscript), p. 242.
11. Deon Morlock, "Lunt Family Records," Letter of 1981.
12. "L.D.S. Journal," L.D.S. Film crmh 1514.
13. William R. Palmer, "Iron County History," (1954) S.U.U. Special Collections Library, Cedar City, Utah.
14. "L.D.S. Cedar Ward Minutes," March 27, 1860, Cedar City, Utah Regional Genealogy Library, L.D.S. Vol. 07363R, CR-1514.